



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Alpine Christian School
School Website: <https://alpinechristianschool.com/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Augustine School (Jackson, TN) — Classicality Audit

Website audited: <https://www.augustineschool.com/>

ACCS accreditation: affirmed in school news post ("now officially accredited by the Association of Classical Christian Schools")

Using the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School keyword framework and lexicon for positive/negative indicators across six categories

Executive Summary

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Why: Augustine School publicly foregrounds the classical Christian telos (truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom and virtue), biblical/theological grounding, and partnership with families. However, the public site materials in the provided crawl do not yet make explicit the curricular and pedagogical distinctives typical of classical schools (e.g., trivium, Latin/logic/rhetoric, Great Books; pedagogy terms like Socratic seminar, memorization/recitation/chant, scholé). Strengthened curricular and pedagogy pages would likely move this school to a full CLASSICAL rating.

Top signals observed: - Religious/metaphysical framing is explicit: "Biblically-Based," "Gospel-Centered," formation "for His Kingdom," "Season of Prayer" guides; repeated appeal to "goodness, truth, and beauty" and "wise and virtuous" formation . - School purpose emphasizes formation (virtue/wisdom) and partnership with families; PK-12 scope, founded 2001, ~210 students; CLT results highlighted (not determinative of classicality, but supportive) . - Curriculum and pedagogy claims are general ("classical model," "classically-informed") without on-site specificity (e.g., trivium/Latin/logic/rhetoric/Socratic/recitation) in the crawl captures.

Key data points: - Grades: PK-12, Students: ~210, Founded: 2001 (as displayed on homepage highlights)

How this audit was done: - Keyword analysis grounded in the Six Essential Elements indicators (positive/negative lists) and the companion lexicon; then quantified per category before assigning ratings .

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

1) Evidence from the site (keywords/phrases found)

- Transcendentals and formation: "form students who love goodness, truth, and beauty," "forming wise and virtuous young men and women" .
- Theology/Christ-centered: "Biblically-Based... God's Word," "Gospel-Centered... Lordship of Christ," "for His Kingdom" .

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- Liturgical/communal practices: “Season of Prayer Guide,” thanksgiving to God in school communications .
- 2) Match to positive/negative indicators (Six Elements/lexicon)
- Positive matches: truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom, virtue; sacred scripture; Christ-centered education; prayer/corporate prayer/worship; reverence. These align tightly with the positive lists for transcendental moral realism, theological grounding, and liturgical/communal practices .
 - No negative indicators (e.g., value-neutrality, secular humanism) were observed.
- 3) Quantification
- Positive hits (distinct): 10
 - truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom; virtue; God’s Word; Gospel; Lordship of Christ; prayer/season of prayer; thanks be to God; Christ-centered formation.
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Percent positive: 100%
 - Coverage (how fully site language maps to the category set): 85%
 - Pos/neg hits: +10/–0
- 4) Rating: CLASSICAL
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CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

- 1) Evidence from the site
- Purpose framed as formation: “form students who love goodness, truth, and beauty,” “forming wise and virtuous young men and women,” “develop... intellect, character, and faith... classically informed” .
 - Lifelong learning: “inspire a lifelong love of learning” .
- 2) Match to indicators
- Positive matches: cultivate wisdom/virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; emphasis on formation not mere information. These align with the positive list for goals (wisdom, virtue, transcendentals, formation) .
 - No explicit negative emphasis on “college and career readiness” or “21st-century skills” as the telos.
- 3) Quantification
- Positive hits (distinct): 6
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Percent positive: 100%
 - Coverage: 80%
 - Pos/neg hits: +6/–0
- 4) Rating: CLASSICAL
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CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

- 1) Evidence from the site
- General descriptors: “Classically-Informed,” “classical model of education,” “excellent literature, the finest art” .
 - ACCS accreditation indicates classical Christian alignment but is not a substitute for stated curricular distinctives on the school’s own pages .

2) Match to indicators

- Limited explicit matches on the site to: trivium/quadrivium; grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin/Greek; Great Books/primary sources; history vs. “social studies”; integrated humanities/sciences; wonder. The crawl did not surface those specific terms on the Academics pages linked from the homepage.

3) Quantification

- Positive hits (distinct): 3 (classical model; classically informed; literature/fine arts)
- Negative hits: 0 (no “project based” dominance, “STEM first,” or “social studies” labeling found)
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage: 35% (few of the core curricular keywords present in crawled pages)
- Pos/neg hits: +3/–0

4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY (TEACHING METHODS)

1) Evidence from the site

- The crawl did not surface explicit pedagogy terms such as: Socratic seminar, dialectic, disputation; memorization/recitation/chanting; restful learning or scholé; imitation/progymnasmata; rhetoric exercises/debates/orations. No counter signals like “project based learning” dominance were found either.

2) Match to indicators

- Insufficient public statements to confirm classical pedagogy from the site materials captured. The Six Elements framework expects explicit signals (e.g., Socratic, recitation/chanting, scholé) for a confident match .

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 0
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 0%
- Coverage: 0%
- Pos/neg hits: +0/–0

4) Rating: NOT CLASSICAL (insufficient evidence published to verify pedagogy)

Note: Given Augustine’s PK–12 scope, lack of explicit HS pedagogy descriptors on the site (Socratic seminars, rhetoric orations) weighs more heavily; K–8 alone could be classical without Socratic, but PK–12 schools typically state these practices publicly.

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

1) Evidence from the site

- “engaging faculty,” thanks to “wonderful teachers and administration” in the accreditation note .

2) Match to indicators

- Partial alignment: positive tone toward teachers; however, the site does not (in the crawl) articulate “teachers as models of virtue,” “living curriculum,” “faculty collegium/formation,” or a “portrait of a teacher/student” that are common in classical schools’ published materials .

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 1
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage: 20% (just thin evidence; not the typical classical faculty language)
- Pos/neg hits: +1/-0

4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 6: PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

1) Evidence from the site

- “partner with families” in core positioning; PK–12 community with parent-facing news/resources (e.g., “Season of Prayer Guide,” “A Classical Christmas,” and a parent gift guide authored by teachers) .

2) Match to indicators

- Positive matches: parent partnership; communal and liturgical community life (events tied to the Christian year); faculty-to-parent communication resources—consistent with the “parents as partners/co-educators” ethos in the lexicon .

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 2
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage: 60%
- Pos/neg hits: +2/-0

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Assessment

- Category ratings: [1] Classical, [2] Classical, [3] Somewhat Classical, [4] Not Classical, [5] Somewhat Classical, [6] Classical.
- Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school’s public materials strongly reflect classical Christian foundations and aims and present a healthy parent-school partnership. To merit a full CLASSICAL rating, the site should explicitly publish curricular specifics (trivium; Latin/logic/rhetoric; Great Books/primary sources; “history” rather than “social studies”) and pedagogy hallmarks (Socratic/dialectic, memorization/recitation/chant, scholé/restful learning, rhetoric orations), which are currently implied but not demonstrated in the crawl captures.

What would move the needle (site-content improvements)

- Curriculum page:
 - Name the trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and quadrivium; list Latin and logic/rhetoric course sequences for grades 7–12; state “history” explicitly and avoid “social studies” language; link to a representative Great Books/primary texts reading list. (All are strong positives in the Six Elements framework) .
- Pedagogy page:

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- Describe K–6 memory work and recitation/chant; 7–12 Socratic seminars/dialectic; debate/oratory and senior thesis/oration in rhetoric years; publish a sample seminar prompt or capstone description. .
 - Faculty formation:
 - Publish a “Portrait of a Teacher” and/or “Faculty of Friends” statement; note teacher formation in classical pedagogy and ongoing Great Books seminars/collegiality. .
 - Parent formation:
 - Add parent reading groups/book studies or classical education workshops as recurring offerings (if already happening, surface them on the site). .
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Detailed Keyword Tables (by Category)

Note: Positive/negative vocab drawn from Six Essential Elements and the classicality lexicon .

- Element 1: Religious/Metaphysical (found on site)
 - Positive: truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom; virtue; God’s Word; Gospel; Lordship of Christ; prayer/season of prayer; thanks be to God; classical Christian education .
 - Negative: none observed.
 - Element 2: Purpose/Goal (found on site)
 - Positive: “forming... wise and virtuous,” “love... goodness, truth, and beauty,” “lifelong love of learning,” “develop... intellect, character, and faith” .
 - Negative: none observed.
 - Element 3: Curriculum (found on site)
 - Positive: “classical model,” “classically informed,” “excellent literature, the finest art” .
 - Absent (and recommended to add): trivium/quadrivium; Latin/logic/rhetoric; Great Books/primary sources; history (versus “social studies”) .
 - Element 4: Pedagogy (found on site)
 - Positive: none explicit (no Socratic, scholé, memorization/recitation/chant, rhetoric orations present in crawl).
 - Negative: none explicit (no “project based learning” dominance).
 - Element 5: Faculty (found on site)
 - Positive: “engaging faculty,” “wonderful teachers and administration” .
 - Absent: teacher as model/mentor; collegial formation; portrait statements .
 - Element 6: Parents & Community (found on site)
 - Positive: “partner with families”; Season of Prayer guide; community/holiday events (“A Classical Christmas”) .
 - Negative: none observed.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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